EXTRA STUDY #001 · English by Jay · B1 · ≈ 11 min

The English words you don't learn unless you go to England.

Watch: youtube.com/watch?v=IXuJSwk1gck
What it covers: 7 everyday British words and phrases that most textbooks skip, a few pronunciation habits (dropped T's, the glottal stop) and a hidden "secret word".

How to use this sheet

1. Do **Warm-up** before you press play.
2. Keep the **word cards** open while you watch. Tick each one and write the timestamp when Jay says it.
3. Do the **exercises** afterwards. The answer key is on the last page.

A note on the order

I couldn't open the video's captions, so I can't promise the cards below follow Jay's exact order. They follow the order of the video's description, and the facts come from the description, the video's vocabulary list (VoiceTube) and standard British usage. If Jay's order is different, just use the timestamp boxes, and keep an eye out for an 8th word, the "secret word".

Warm-up · before you watch (2 min)

1. Have you heard any of these from British players online? **cheers** · **innit** · **gutted** · **proper** · **cheeky**. Guess what each one means.
2. **Prediction:** Jay calls them words "you don't learn unless you go to England". Why might a textbook leave them out?
3. Say *"a cup of tea"* quickly, five times. What happens to the word *of*?

The words

1 · cuppa /ˈkʌpə/ noun, informal

Meaning: a cup of tea (sometimes coffee). ☐ heard it at _____

"Fancy a cuppa?" = Would you like a cup of tea?
"I'll put the kettle on and make us a cuppa."

Why it sounds like that: *cup of* → *cup'a*. The weak form of *of* is just /ə/, and in fast speech the /v/ disappears.

Family words to listen for: brew (*"Shall I make a brew?"*, mainly northern England), **kettle**, **mug**, **biscuit**, **to dunk** (dip a biscuit in your tea), **digestive** (a plain British biscuit), **fancy** (= want).



a cuppa and two digestives (ready for dunking)

Jay's tip The description spells it "cupper", but the normal spelling is **cuppa**. A **proper cuppa** is a real, strong cup of tea, made properly (see card 7).

2 · cheeky /ˈtʃiːki/ adjective

Meaning 1: slightly rude or disrespectful, but in a playful or funny way. ☐ heard it at _____

"Don't be cheeky!" *"He gave me a cheeky grin."*

Meaning 2 (very British): used for a small treat or something done on impulse, a bit naughty but harmless.

"Fancy a cheeky biscuit?" *"Let's get a cheeky pint after the lab."*

In your games *"That was a cheeky flank!"* means a sneaky, slightly unfair but clever play. Usually it's a compliment, not an insult.

3 · gutted /ˈgʌʔɪd/ adjective, informal

Meaning: extremely disappointed or sad about something. ☐ heard it at _____

"I'm gutted we lost on the last point."

"She was absolutely gutted when the concert was cancelled."

Sound: the *tt* often becomes a **glottal stop** /ʔ/, so it sounds like "gu'-id". Listen for it!

Strong words go together: *absolutely gutted*, *proper gutted*, *devastated* (even stronger).



gutted

4 · buzzing /ˈbʌzɪŋ/ adjective, informal

Meaning: very excited, happy or full of energy. ☐ heard it at _____

"I'm buzzing for the new season!"

"The whole team was buzzing after the win."

Opposite pair: *gutted* ↔ *buzzing*. A perfect pair for after a match.

Also: *The place was buzzing* = full of people and activity. (A **buzz** is the sound bees make.)



buzzing

5 · innit /ˈɪnɪʔ/ question tag, very informal

Meaning: a short form of *isn't it*, used to ask for agreement or just to keep the conversation going. ☐ heard it at _____

"It's freezing today, innit?" = It's freezing, isn't it?

The surprising part: in casual London speech, *innit* can follow *any* subject or tense:

"You're from Belgium, innit?" (= aren't you?) *"He played well, innit?"* (= didn't he?)

Grammar link Standard English changes the tag to match the verb: *It **is**… isn't it?* · *You **are**… aren't you?* · *He **played**… didn't he? Innit* skips all of that. Understand it, but in exams always use the full, matching tag.

6 · cheers /tʃɪəz/ exclamation

Three uses: ☐ heard it at _____

1. **Thank you** (the most common): *"Cheers, mate!"* when someone passes you the salt, or revives you in a game.
2. **Goodbye**: *"Right, cheers then, see you tomorrow."*
3. **A toast** when you lift your glasses together: *"Cheers!"*

Sound: no /r/! Southern British English is **non-rhotic**, so *cheers* sounds like "chee-uhz".

7 · proper /ˈprɒpə/ adjective / adverb, informal

Meaning 1 (adj.): real, genuine, done correctly. ☐ heard it at _____

"Let's have a proper cup of tea." *"We need a proper plan this time."*

Meaning 2 (adv., informal): very, really.

"That boss fight was proper hard." *"I'm proper tired."*

Sound: again the final *-er* is just /ə/, with no /r/.

8 · the secret word *your turn*

Jay hides an extra word somewhere in the video. When you hear it, write it here:

Word: _____ Meaning: _____ Time: _____

Pronunciation lab: why British speech is hard to catch

1. The glottal stop /ʔ/. Many British speakers replace a /t/ in the middle or at the end of a word with a tiny "catch" in the throat: the vocal folds snap shut for a moment, like in the middle of *uh-oh*.

better	"be'-uh" /'beʔə/
water	"wa'-uh" /'wɔːʔə/
a lot of	"a lo' of" /ə'lɒʔəv/
gutted	"gu'-id"
innit	"inni'"

2. No /r/ after vowels (non-rhotic): *cheers, proper, better, here* have no /r/ sound unless the next word starts with a vowel (*better **r**off*).

3. Weak forms: *of, to, for, a* shrink to /ə/: *cup of* → *cuppa*.

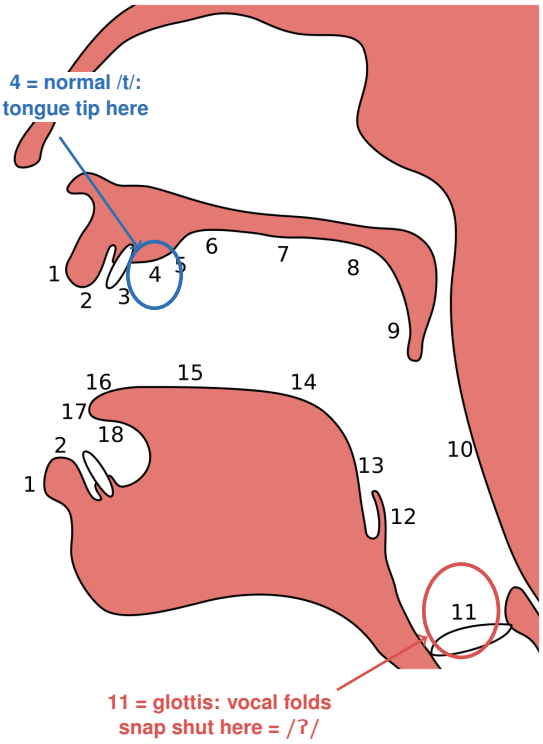


Diagram: "Places of articulation", Wikimedia Commons

Try it Say *uh-oh*. Feel that stop in your throat between the two sounds? That's /ʔ/. Now say *buʔer* for *butter*.

Also listen for these (from the video's vocabulary list)

every cloud has a silver lining: something good comes out of every bad situation
lost for words: so surprised you can't speak
stick around: stay, don't leave
to let: (on a sign) available to rent

fancy (verb): want, would like
gorgeous: very beautiful or pleasant
on top of that: in addition
stay afloat: just manage to survive (often money)

Exercises · after you watch

A · Match the word to its meaning

1. cuppa	a) very excited
2. cheeky	b) thank you / goodbye
3. gutted	c) very, really
4. buzzing	d) a cup of tea
5. innit	e) isn't it?
6. cheers	f) playfully rude
7. proper (adv.)	g) very disappointed

1 ____ 2 ____ 3 ____ 4 ____ 5 ____ 6 ____ 7 ____

B · Voice chat: fill the gaps

Use: **cheers** · **gutted** · **buzzing** · **cheeky** · **proper** · **cuppa** · **innit**

1. "Nice one for healing me, _____!"
2. "We were one point away from winning. I'm absolutely _____."
3. "Did you see that _____ flank? He came round the back and nobody noticed."
4. "That map is _____ hard on defence."
5. "New season starts tomorrow, I'm _____!"
6. "Brb, gonna make a _____ and grab a biscuit."
7. "It's a bit laggy tonight, _____?"

C · Which meaning?

Choose the best meaning of the **bold** word.

1. "Right, **cheers**, mate, see you tomorrow." a) thank you b) goodbye c) a toast
2. "Let's have a **proper** meal, not just crisps." a) very b) real, decent c) polite
3. "You ate my last biscuit? **Cheeky**!" a) angry insult b) playful complaint c) compliment
4. "The pub was **buzzing** last night." a) noisy with bees b) empty c) busy and lively

D · Pronunciation: spot the glottal stop

Underline each **t** that a British speaker could say as a glottal stop /ʔ/.

1. That was a lot of fun.
2. Get a bottle of water.
3. I'm gutted, innit.
4. Put it on the table. *(careful: not every t!)*

E · Grammar link: correct question tags

Your friend writes *innit* every time. Rewrite each one with the **standard** tag.

1. You're coming tonight, innit? → You're coming tonight, _____?
2. He lost again, innit? → He lost again, _____?
3. They've finished, innit? → They've finished, _____?
4. It was a good game, innit? → It was a good game, _____?

F · Your turn (output)

Write 3 sentences you could say after an online match. Use at least **three** words from this sheet. Then say them aloud with a glottal stop in *gutted*, *a lot of* or *better*.

_____

_____

_____

Answer key

Warm-up

1. cheers = thanks/bye; innit = isn't it; gutted = very disappointed; proper = real / very; cheeky = playfully rude. **2.** They're informal and spoken, and many are regional, so textbooks focus on neutral standard English instead. **3.** *of* becomes /ə/: "a cuppa tea".

A · Match

1 d 2 f 3 g 4 a 5 e 6 b 7 c

B · Gaps

1 cheers 2 gutted 3 cheeky 4 proper 5 buzzing 6 cuppa 7 innit

C · Which meaning?

1 b (goodbye) 2 b (real, decent) 3 b (playful complaint) 4 c (busy and lively)

D · Glottal stops

1. That was a lot of fun. (both)
2. Get a bottle of water. (all three)
3. I'm gutted, innit. (both)
4. Put it on the table. The *t* in *table* stays a normal /t/, because it starts a stressed syllable.

E · Question tags

1 aren't you? 2 didn't he? 3 haven't they? 4 wasn't it?

F · Model answer

"GG everyone, cheers for the heals. I'm proper gutted we lost that last round, but that cheeky flank on B was brilliant. I'm buzzing for the next one."

Image credits (Wikimedia Commons): *Tea and digestive biscuits* by Sean MacEntee (2014), CC BY 2.0. *Places of articulation* by ish shwar, CC BY-SA 3.0; labels added. Emoji "disappointed face" (U+1F61E) and "grinning squinting face" (U+1F606) from Google Noto Emoji, Apache License 2.0.

Made to go with English by Jay's video. Content checked against the video's description and vocabulary list; usage notes follow standard British English.